

Helix Thready — TUI Lipgloss Theme

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Rev	Date	Author	Change
1	2026-07-22	swarm (design · screens)	Initial: token→ <code>lipgloss.Color</code> map with VERIFIED/ASSUMED provenance, ANSI-256/16 degradation, role styles, adaptive option

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1. Provenance rules

Per the no-bluff bar (`CONVENTIONS.md §7`), every value below is tagged:

- **VERIFIED** — the hex value comes verbatim from `tokens/themes/thready.css` (design-system.md §3.2, itself `[VERIFIED — IN-HOUSE: design_system]`), or the style-role pattern comes from the

inspected in-house Bubble Tea program `helix_track/llms_verifier/llm-verifier/tui` (`wireframes.md §5.2`).

- **ASSUMED** — a mapping judgment made here (nearest ANSI-256/16 index, light-terminal adaptive pairing, `CompleteColor` usage) that ground truth does not pin down. Assumed values **MUST** be re-verified at integration (run Lipgloss’s own degradation and eyeball on a 16-color terminal).
- The Go palette *shape* below follows the generated-bindings sample in `design-system.md §7`, which is itself `[DEFAULT — adjustable]` — the palette is **generated from** `thready.css`, never hand-kept.

The TUI defaults to the **dark** theme values (“the TUI defaults to the terminal’s dark surface”, `design-system §7 [VERIFIED — the generated sample uses the dark palette]`).

2. Token → color map

Role	CSS token	Truecolor (dark)	Truecolor provenance	ANSI-256	ANSI-16	Mapping provenance
Accent / selection bg	<code>--accent</code>	#B6E376	VERIFIED	150	10 bright-green	ASSUMED
Accent ink (on accent)	<code>--accent-on</code>	#0A0F04	VERIFIED	16	0 black	ASSUMED
Foreground	<code>--fg</code>	#F8FAFC	VERIFIED	255	15 bright-white	ASSUMED
Muted / help / meta	<code>--muted</code>	#94A3B8	VERIFIED	103	7 white	ASSUMED
Border / status bar bg	<code>--border</code>	#1E293B	VERIFIED	236	8 bright-black	ASSUMED
Strong boundary	<code>--border-strong</code>	#64748B	VERIFIED	102	8 bright-black	ASSUMED
Success	<code>--success</code>	#16A34A	VERIFIED	35	2 green	ASSUMED
Warn	<code>--warn</code>	#EAB308	VERIFIED	178	11 bright-yellow	ASSUMED
Danger	<code>--danger</code>	#EF4444	VERIFIED	203	9 bright-red	ASSUMED
	<code>--brand</code>	#B6E376	VERIFIED	150		ASSUMED

Role	CSS token	Truecolor (dark)	Truecolor provenance	ANSI-256	ANSI-16	Mapping provenance
Brand (decorative)					10 bright-green	
Brand-2 / titles	-- brand-2	#B7EBD6	VERIFIED (Logo.png median, dark)	152	14 bright-cyan	ASSUMED
Background	--bg	#020817	VERIFIED	232	0 black (terminal default)	ASSUMED
Surface-warm	-- surface-warm	#1E293B	VERIFIED	236	8 bright-black	ASSUMED

Light-theme counterparts (`--accent #446E12`, `--fg #020817`, `--muted #475569`, ...) are equally **VERIFIED** from the same theme file and are used only by the adaptive option in §6.

3. Palette package (Go)

Generated from `tokens/themes/thready.css` by the token-export step (OpenDesign `tokensToJson` → codegen, design-system §7). Hex values **VERIFIED**; the code shape extends the design-system §7 sample `[DEFAULT — adjustable]`:

```
// Package theme is GENERATED from tokens/themes/thready.css — do not edit by hand.
// Dark palette: the TUI defaults to the terminal's dark surface (design-system $7).
package theme

import "github.com/charmbracelet/lipgloss"

var (
    Accent      = lipgloss.Color("#B6E376") // --accent (dark)           [VERIFIED]
    AccentOn    = lipgloss.Color("#0A0F04") // --accent-on                [VERIFIED]
    Fg          = lipgloss.Color("#F8FAFC") // --fg                       [VERIFIED]
    Muted       = lipgloss.Color("#94A3B8") // --muted                    [VERIFIED]
    BorderColor = lipgloss.Color("#1E293B") // --border                   [VERIFIED]
    BorderHard  = lipgloss.Color("#64748B") // --border-strong            [VERIFIED]
    Success     = lipgloss.Color("#16A34A") // --success                  [VERIFIED]
    Warn        = lipgloss.Color("#EAB308") // --warn                     [VERIFIED]
    DangerColor = lipgloss.Color("#EF4444") // --danger                   [VERIFIED]
    Brand2      = lipgloss.Color("#B7EBD6") // --brand-2 (dark median)    [VERIFIED]
)
```

4. Role styles (verified bindings, tokenized)

The role set is the **verified** binding table of wireframes \$5.2 — the in-house reference builds exactly these roles with raw ANSI indices (`"205"`, `"39"`, `"240"`, `"62"`, `"241"` `[VERIFIED — llm-verifier app.go]`); Thready re-binds them to the generated palette:

```
// tui/theme_bindings.go - roles VERIFIED (llm-verifier pattern); values from $3.
var (
    Title    = lipgloss.NewStyle().Foreground(Accent).Bold(true)           // was Color("205")
    Header   = lipgloss.NewStyle().Foreground(Brand2).Bold(true)           // pane titles (Thready
        addition, ASSUMED)
    NavOn    = lipgloss.NewStyle().Foreground(Accent)                       // active tab    (was "39")
    NavOff   = lipgloss.NewStyle().Foreground(Muted)                       // inactive tab (was "240")
    Border   = lipgloss.NewStyle().BorderForeground(BorderColor)           // header/footer border
        (was "62")
    Help     = lipgloss.NewStyle().Foreground(Muted)                       // key hints    (was "241")
    Danger   = lipgloss.NewStyle().Foreground(DangerColor)                 // failed steps / retry
    Ok       = lipgloss.NewStyle().Foreground(Success)                     // ✓ processed  (ASSUMED
        addition)
    Warning  = lipgloss.NewStyle().Foreground(Warn)                        // ⚠ auth / degraded
        (ASSUMED addition)

    // Selection + button: accent fill with accent-on ink - mirrors design-system $7 Button
    [DEFAULT - adjustable].
    Selected = lipgloss.NewStyle().Foreground(AccentOn).Background(Accent)
    Button   = lipgloss.NewStyle().Foreground(AccentOn).Background(Accent).Padding(0,
        2).Bold(true)
    StatusBar = lipgloss.NewStyle().Foreground(Muted).Background(lipgloss.Color("#1E293B")) //
        --surface-warm dark
    Heart     = lipgloss.NewStyle().Foreground(Accent) // ♥ U+2665 in the locked footer (brand-
        assets $8)
)
```

5. Degradation: truecolor → ANSI-256 → ANSI-16

Ground truth says only: “Under a non-truecolor terminal the tokens degrade to the nearest 256-color; border styles (not just color) keep boundaries legible” (wireframes \$5.2 [\[VERIFIED\]](#)). Two implementation options — both **ASSUMED** until tested on a 16-color terminal:

1. **Automatic (default):** `lipgloss.Color("#B6E376")` — Lipgloss/termenv degrades to the nearest supported color per the terminal’s advertised profile. Zero code, but the ANSI-16 result is not pinned.
2. **Pinned (recommended for the 16-color floor):** `lipgloss.CompleteColor` fixes every profile explicitly, using the \$2 table:

```
// ASSUMED - pin the degradation so a 16-color terminal gets a deliberate palette, not a guess.
var AccentC = lipgloss.CompleteColor{TrueColor: "#B6E376", ANSI256: "150", ANSI: "10"}
var MutedC  = lipgloss.CompleteColor{TrueColor: "#94A3B8", ANSI256: "103", ANSI: "7"}
var DangerC = lipgloss.CompleteColor{TrueColor: "#EF4444", ANSI256: "203", ANSI: "9"}
// ... full set per the $2 table.
```

Legibility caveat (also noted in [tui-screens.html](#)): the true `--border #1E293B` is nearly invisible on the `#020817` terminal background (~1.3:1). That is consistent with the web rule that borders are subtle, but on ANSI-16 terminals the border maps to `8` bright-black, which typically renders ≈ `#475569`-ish — *more* visible than truecolor. The mockups draw box glyphs with that ANSI-8 approximation for legibility. If

truecolor borders prove illegible in practice, promote box glyphs to `--border-strong` `#64748B` — tracked as `[OPEN: THREADY-DES-17]`.

6. Light-terminal / adaptive option

Ground truth fixes the **dark** default; nothing forbids a light terminal. **ASSUMED** option using the equally-verified light token values:

```
// ASSUMED — adaptive pairing from the same theme file (light values are VERIFIED tokens).
var AccentA = lipgloss.AdaptiveColor{Light: "#446E12", Dark: "#B6E376"} // --accent light/dark
var FgA     = lipgloss.AdaptiveColor{Light: "#020817", Dark: "#F8FAFC"} // --fg
var MutedA  = lipgloss.AdaptiveColor{Light: "#475569", Dark: "#94A3B8"} // --muted
var DangerA = lipgloss.AdaptiveColor{Light: "#DC2626", Dark: "#EF4444"} // --danger
```

Adopting this is a product decision (the TUI currently ships dark-only) — fold into `[OPEN: THREADY-DES-17]`.

7. White-label re-tinting

Because the palette is generated from the same token source as every other surface, a per-Account white-label re-tints the TUI without touching Go: the resolver emits a regenerated Lipgloss palette from the effective brand, read at login from `GET /v1/accounts/{id}/branding` (theming §8 `[VERIFIED — stated mechanism]`). Only `Accent` / `AccentOn` / `Brand2` change; neutrals and semantics stay fixed, so `--danger` can never be masked by a brand color (theming §10.2).

8. Open items

- `[OPEN: THREADY-DES-17]` — TUI degradation decisions: (a) automatic vs. pinned `CompleteColor` ANSI-16 mapping (all §2 ANSI columns are ASSUMED nearest-color picks);
 1. border glyph color under truecolor (`--border` vs. `--border-strong`); (c) whether to ship the light-terminal adaptive palette (§6). Verify on real 16-color and truecolor terminals.
- The generated-palette codegen step itself is part of `THREADY-DES-DS-01` / the token-bridge workable items (design-system §9) — this file specifies its TUI output, it does not claim the generator exists.

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